

r/vegan

water use of AI vs. animal products

Posted by u/snowy4_ • 0 points • 114 comments

chatgpt just put out a spotify wrapped sort of thing and it said that i sent 1,301 messages in 2025. i decided to put that amount into a water consumption calculator thing *(omnicalculator.com/ecology/ai-water-footprint)* and it turns my AI usage in 2025 used roughly 13 gallons of water. so not a lot but still bad

however, i then went to a vegan impact calculator *(vegancalculator.com)* and put in 1 year (i've been vegan longer than that but 1 year is the same time as what's accounted for in the chatgpt spotify wrapped thing). and, in just a year of being vegan, i **saved** 401,766 gallons of water.

im not trying to excuse AI, its water consumption is still bad, but it's fascinating how much worse animal products are, and how little people care.

and that kinda proves my belief that most self identified leftists / environmentalists normally won't actually make any personal changes to help. they'll do something like boycott AI (still a good thing, just not very impactful) but when it comes to changing their own life and taking away some convenience (going vegan, something infinitely more impactful) they spit out excuses and avoid the thought at all costs.

they stay willfully ignorant of how much worse for the environment animal agriculture is than AI, and just continue to virtue signal on social media about boycotting AI (something that is very easy to do) acting like they are the leading force of the environmental movement.

(just to clarify, i do not support widespread AI use, especially generative AI, and think the continued push for its use in every part of society is very damaging. in no way is this post meant to justify AI use. i'm just pointing out hypocrisy, something we all love doing)

Comments

u/LadyduLac1018 • 4 points • 2026-01-15 21:18 UTC

"Over three-quarters of global agricultural land is allocated to livestock, despite meat and dairy contributing a smaller portion of global protein and calories."

Ai is bad for other things but environmentally the only thing to do is become a vegan